

34.5%

Search runs on 34.5% of queries. The rest is memory.

Down from 46%. When search is off the model answers from what it already read, so absence from that memory costs you quietly.

Queries with search enabled, late 2024	46%
Queries with search enabled, Feb 2026	34.5%
OUTBOUND REFERRAL GROWTH, JAN 2025 TO JAN 2026	+206%
REFERRALS LANDING ON GOOGLE INSTEAD	21.6%

Semrush, 17-month ChatGPT clickstream study, October 2024 to February 2026.